



Social Psychology (SOCPSY)

Module 6: Attitudes, Conformity and Obedience

Attitudes and Cognitive Dissonance

Lesson Notes

KMVTECHUG

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Attitudes

An attitude is an evaluation of a person, object, or idea. It includes beliefs, feelings, and action tendencies. Attitudes guide what we notice and how we respond, but they do not always predict behaviour perfectly.

Attitude Change

Persuasion depends on the message, the source, and the audience. Strong arguments matter more when people are motivated to think carefully. Credible and likeable sources help. Audience knowledge and mood matter too.

Cognitive Dissonance

Cognitive dissonance is the discomfort that arises when beliefs and actions conflict. People often reduce it by changing an attitude, changing behaviour, or adding a justifying belief. A student who values honesty but cheats may later downplay the importance of the rule.

Reflect: Have you ever changed a belief to match something you already did? What was the situation?

Closing

Attitudes and dissonance set up the final lesson on conformity, obedience, and resisting harmful influence.